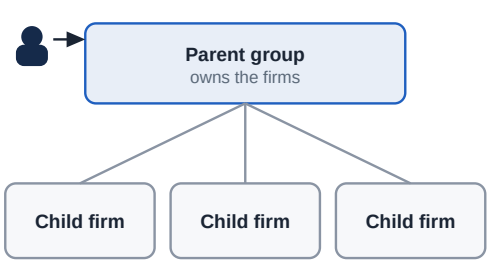
Multi-firm scenarios, simplified

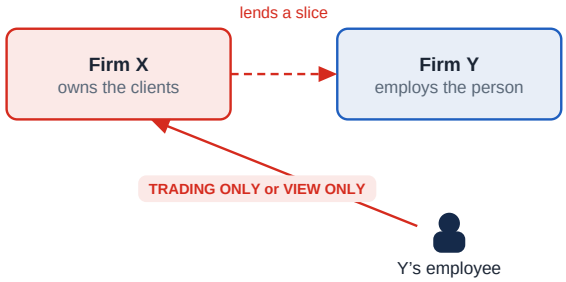
Every firm situation Penny walked through in the KT sessions and the PRD, in plain words, with an example, the problem it causes today, what she concluded, and where it stands in the current mock. Internal working document.

The two patterns everything falls into



AGGREGATION · “I own it, give me the whole picture”

vertical · one profile · one layer · relationship comes from Firm360



DELEGATION · “I lend you a slice, no more than I lent”

horizontal · a ceiling set by the lender · not in Firm360 yet

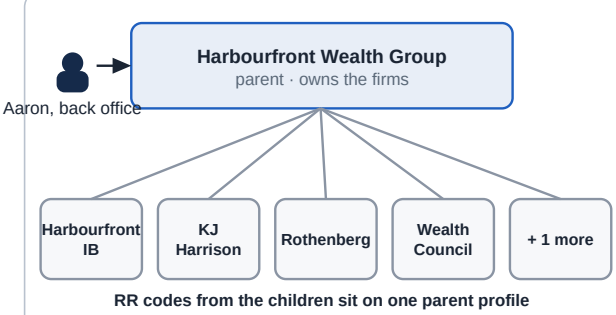
Aggregation	Delegation	Both
85 parent groups, 184 child firms. 80% of parents have exactly two children; Harbourfront has five plus Cumberland. 78 parent users today; 58% of groups have no parent user yet. 292 people hold duplicate Compass accounts.	45 sub-advisors serving 35 firms. 741 R2 profiles carry sub-advisor RR codes (846 codes). Up to a quarter of firms have some sub-advisory relationship.	About 40% of active firms sit in a cross-firm relationship. Secured Zone checks no firm boundary at all, which is why Penny framed cross-firm access as a privacy exposure first and a convenience second.

Status tag	Meaning
COVERED IN THE MOCK	The light-UAR + multi-firm mock handles it as drawn
PHASE 2 · WITH TRADING	Deferred with the sub-advisory (delegation) phase, needed by trading GA
OUT OF SCOPE	Penny ruled it out; nothing to design
OPEN · NEEDS A DECISION	A choice she left open; the mock took a position that needs confirming
A RULE, NOT A BUILD	Handled by a rule or an operating practice, not by software

The pattern Penny kept coming back to: aggregation is “I own it, give me the whole picture”; delegation is “I lend you a slice, and you can’t take more than I lent.”

A · Aggregation: parent and child firms

One company owns several firms registered with NBIN. The people at head office need to see and service everything the group owns. The relationship is ownership, so it already lives in Firm360 (the Parent_Code field, one layer deep).



Today: up to 28 IDs per person (7 Compass + 7 NetRep + 7 Secured Zone). Target: one ID at the parent.

A1 · Parent group built by acquisitions

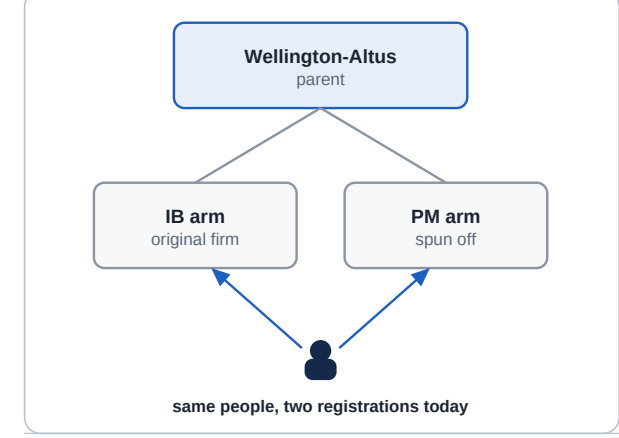
What it is. A firm buys other firms and keeps them as separate registrations under one group. Head-office staff work across all of them.

Example. Harbourfront: Harbourfront IB, KJ Harrison, Rothenberg, Wealth Council and more. Aaron in the back office exists in seven firms and can hold up to 28 logins.

Problem today. Head office logs into every firm separately; attestation sees seven Aarons, not one person.

Penny's conclusion. The core case. Set the person up once at the parent, one Compass ID with RR codes from the children. One layer of hierarchy only.

COVERED IN THE MOCK Screens A and E: parent group user with RR codes per child firm; one row per person; consolidation of existing IDs.



A2 · One business with two arms

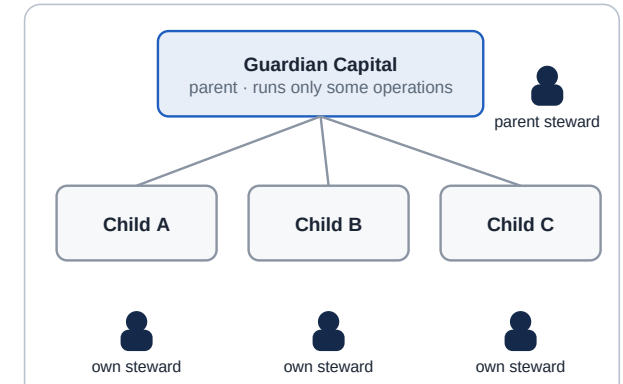
What it is. A firm runs two regulated arms, for example an introducing broker that spun off a portfolio-management firm. Same staff, two registrations.

Example. Wellington-Altus: an IB firm and a PM firm.

Problem today. Two sets of logins for the same people; two user lists to attest.

Penny's conclusion. Treat as parent/child, one layer. The parent gets everything both arms subscribe to.

COVERED IN THE MOCK Same mechanism as A1. Nothing extra to build.



Children keep their own stewards. Only people who manage across children are set up at the parent.

A3 · Parent that only does some operations

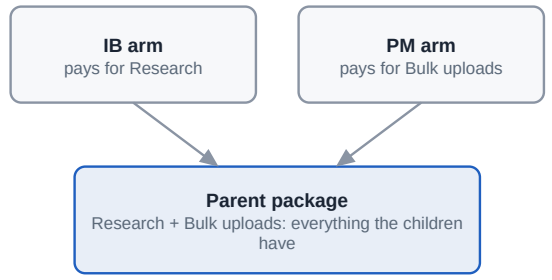
What it is. The group exists, but most of the business and the stewards sit in the child firms. The parent steward knows little about each child's users.

Example. Guardian Capital.

Problem today. Each child already has its own steward and its own users; the parent itself has few.

Penny's conclusion. Fine as it is. Children keep their stewards; only people who manage across children are set up at the parent.

COVERED IN THE MOCK Screen E designates a group steward and keeps single-firm stewards; Screen A lets the group steward request for the parent. Placing a user in one specific child from the parent steward's form is the fix still to apply.



Count what parent users are assigned and bill by metering. No licence caps managed in Compass.

A4 · Feature mix after a merger

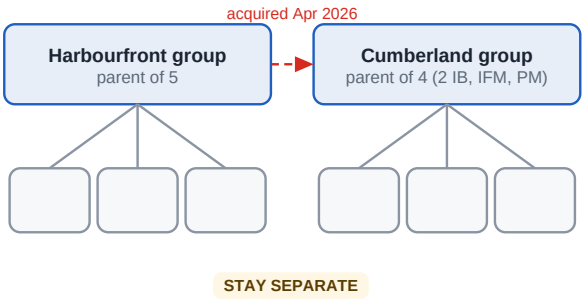
What it is. Children subscribe to different add-ons. One arm pays for research, the other for bulk uploads; one is on Croesus, the other on Digit.

Example. Harbourfront's IB arm versus an acquired PM arm; Cumberland subscribed to research, Harbourfront did not.

Problem today. Nobody can say what a parent user is entitled to.

Penny's conclusion. A parent user may be assigned anything a child subscribes to. Build one global parent package containing everything, configure it manually, and bill by metering assigned users and accounts. No inheritance automation; conflicts on merger are a contract question for Ray's team.

COVERED IN THE MOCK Screen E: global parent package with child-only modules locked. Metering and billing to Firm360 are sequenced last, as Penny asked.



Until operations merge and contracts are renegotiated. Then Firm360 is updated and Cumberland's four firms list under Harbourfront.

A5 · Acquisition not yet merged

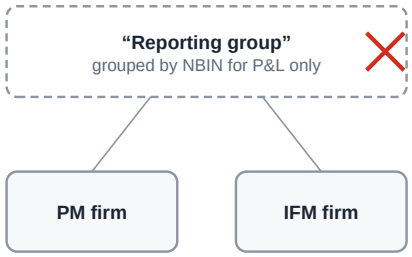
What it is. A parent buys another parent group but has not merged operations or renegotiated contracts yet.

Example. Harbourfront bought Cumberland in April 2026; Cumberland is itself a parent of two IBs, an IFM and a PM.

Problem today. Two parent groups that are legally one; the temptation is to fold them together in Compass early.

Penny's conclusion. Keep them separate until the firm formalizes the operating change. Then Firm360 is updated and Cumberland's four firms list under Harbourfront.

A RULE, NOT A BUILD The mock reads the group from Firm360, so it follows whatever Firm360 says. Nothing to build; an operating rule for Product Activation.



Not a real parent: no users, no accounts, no contract. Never register anyone there.

A6 · "Ghost parent": a pair grouped only for reporting

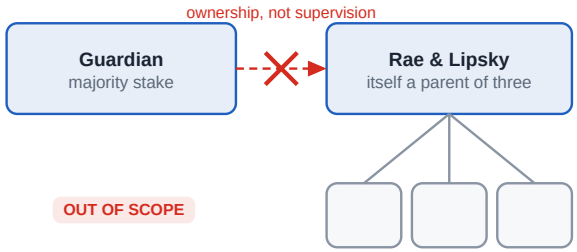
What it is. NBIN groups a PM firm and an IFM firm under one code for its own P&L reporting. In the data it looks like a parent.

Example. Many PM + IFM pairs.

Problem today. Someone could set up a parent steward or parent users in a group that has no users, accounts or contract.

Penny's conclusion. Not a real parent. Never register anyone there.

A RULE, NOT A BUILD Product Activation simply does not activate it as a parent in Compass. Worth a flag in Firm360 or in Screen E so nobody does it by mistake.



A parent means direct ownership, supervision and accountability. One layer only; no parent of a parent.

A7 · Ownership stake without supervision (parent of a parent)

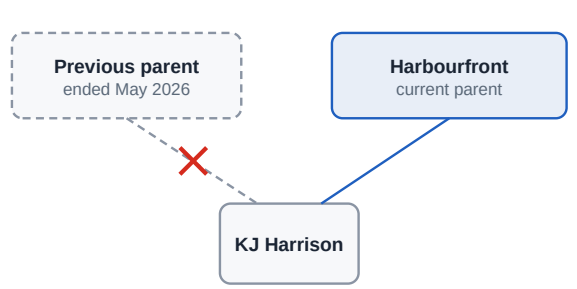
What it is. A firm holds a majority stake in another parent group but does not run it day to day.

Example. Guardian's majority stake in Rae & Lipsky, itself a parent of three; its COO asked NBIN for support.

Problem today. Looks like a second layer of hierarchy.

Penny's conclusion. Out of scope. A parent means direct ownership, supervision and accountability. One layer only.

OUT OF SCOPE Screen E models one layer; nothing more.



Two parents for a while during a move. It resolves itself; don't design for it.

A8 · Multi-parent during a move (transitional)

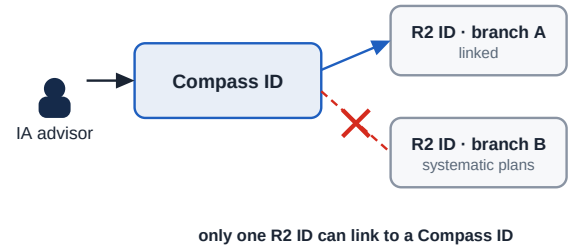
What it is. For a short period a child firm shows two parents, the old and the new, while an acquisition settles.

Example. Harbourfront and KJ Harrison before May 2026.

Problem today. An edge case in the data that confuses any automated sync.

Penny's conclusion. It resolves itself. Don't design for it.

OUT OF SCOPE Not modelled.



Known edge: Industrial Alliance. Don't solve it; it disappears when systematic plans is rebuilt in Compass (2027).

A9 · Legacy-ID edge: a second R2 ID

What it is. A person needs two R2 logins for one function that R2 still does per branch.

Example. Industrial Alliance, the biggest broker: a second R2 ID to view systematic plans in another branch.

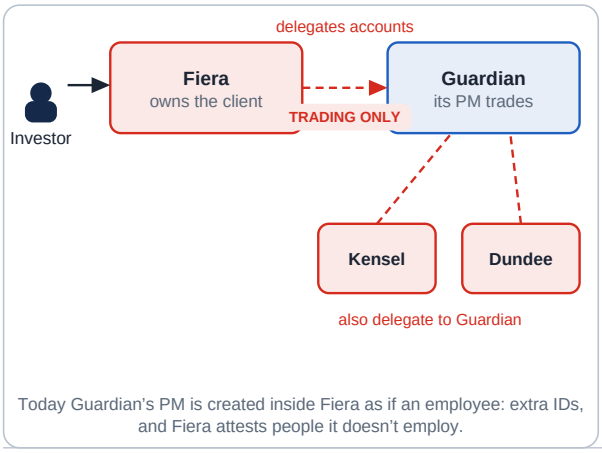
Problem today. Only one R2 ID can be linked to a Compass ID.

Penny's conclusion. Don't solve it. It disappears when systematic plans is rebuilt in Compass in 2027. Multi-firm removes the need for multiple R2 IDs everywhere else.

A RULE, NOT A BUILD The mock's R2 wording will be corrected to say exactly this: the kept Compass ID keeps its single R2 link; other R2 IDs stay direct R2 logins until R2 is powered down.

B · Delegation: a firm lends a slice of its clients to a partner

Two independent firms with a contract between them. The firm that owns the clients lends a narrow slice of access to a person employed by the other firm, and sets the ceiling. The relationship does not exist in Firm360 yet; it lives in sub-advisory agreements on paper.



Today Guardian's PM is created inside Fiera as if an employee: extra IDs, and Fiera attests people it doesn't employ.

B1 · Sub-advisory: trading only

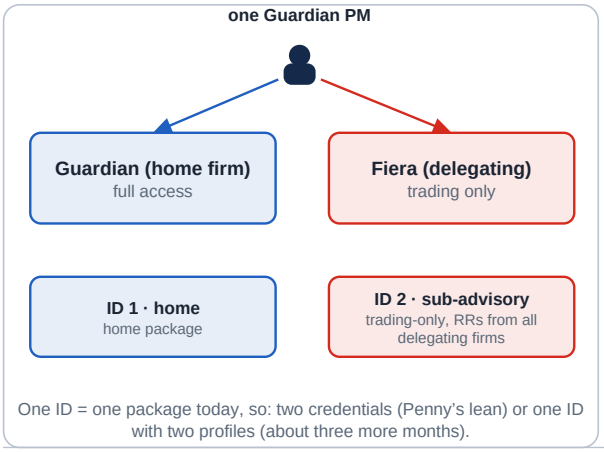
What it is. An investor signs with firm X. X delegates portfolio management to firm Y. Y's portfolio manager places trades on X's accounts.

Example. The investor signs with Fiera; Fiera delegates to Guardian; a Guardian PM trades Fiera accounts. Guardian also sub-advises Kensel and Dundee.

Problem today. Guardian's PM is created inside Fiera as if an employee: three extra IDs, and Fiera's steward attests people Fiera doesn't employ.

Penny's conclusion. Fiera authorizes; Guardian's steward administers; access is trading only (positions, transactions, orders; no PII, no money movement, no exports).

PHASE 2 · WITH TRADING The greyed "Sub-advisory access" card on Screen A is the placeholder. Deferred because sub-advisors trade on NetRep until trading is in Compass.



One ID = one package today, so: two credentials (Penny's lean) or one ID with two profiles (about three more months).

B2 · Same person, two roles

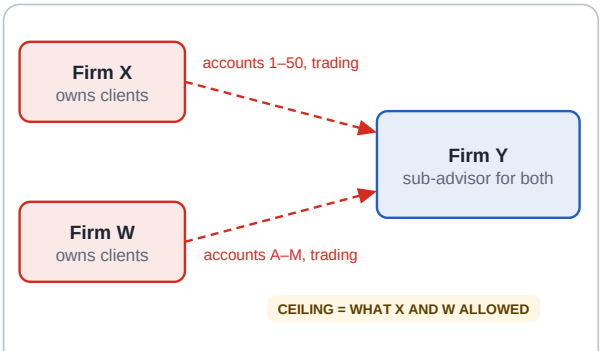
What it is. The same portfolio manager has full access at home and trading-only access at the delegating firm.

Example. A Guardian PM with full access on Guardian accounts and trading-only on Fiera's.

Problem today. One Compass ID can only carry one package, so one person cannot hold two different feature profiles.

Penny's conclusion. Current thinking: two credentials, a home-firm ID plus one "sub-advisory" trading ID covering all delegating firms. Ask R&D what one ID with two profiles would cost (about three months) before accepting that.

OPEN · NEEDS A DECISION Not in the mock. The biggest open design call for phase 2.



Y's steward administers Y's people but cannot assign more than X or W authorized. Compass must enforce that.

B3 · Two firms sharing a sub-advisor

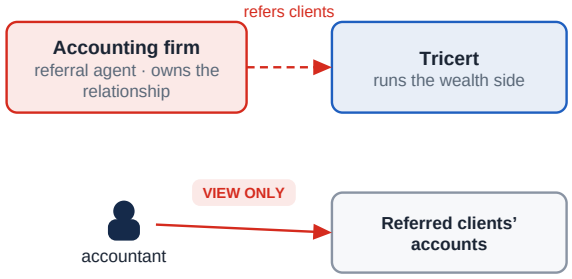
What it is. Two client-owning firms each delegate some accounts to the same partner firm.

Example. Firm X and Firm W each delegate to Firm Y (Penny's whiteboard case).

Problem today. Y's steward could grant Y's people more than X or W allowed.

Penny's conclusion. X's authorization defines the ceiling; Compass must stop Y assigning beyond it. The relationship type sets permissible access and Compass enforces it.

PHASE 2 · WITH TRADING Needs the relationship list on Screen E to carry a type and a ceiling. Build Screen E's list as a generic relationship list now so this is a data change later.



A second delegation type. Sometimes account opening; never trading. Suzanne and Matt hold the list.

B4 · Referral agent: view only

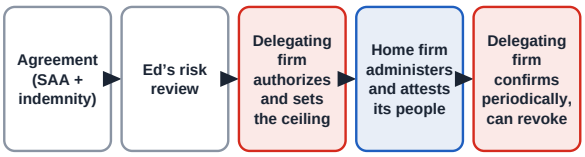
What it is. A partner that owns the client relationship, usually an accounting firm, needs to see the accounts it referred. Sometimes it opens accounts. Never trading.

Example. Tricert: accounting firms own the clients, Tricert runs the wealth side, the accountants need to see the accounts.

Problem today. They look like ordinary employees with cross-firm access.

Penny's conclusion. A second delegation type: view only, sometimes account opening. Suzanne and Matt have the list of referral agents.

PHASE 2 · WITH TRADING Same mechanism as B1 with a different ceiling. Requirements were never written; the list of agents is the first task.



Nothing is released before the first two steps. The home firm attests the person; the delegating firm attests the relationship.

B5 · Governance: who authorizes, attests and revokes

What it is. The rules around any delegation: nothing is released without an agreement and a risk review, the home firm vouches for the person, the delegating firm vouches for the relationship.

Example. Ed owns the liability and indemnity agreement and the risk review of the counterparty; Jonathan (privacy) defines enforcement points.

Problem today. Agreement on paper; nobody is sure who certifies what. Penny's framing: cross-firm access is a privacy breach unless authorized.

Penny's conclusion. Agreement and Ed's review before any account release. The home firm manages and attests its own users. The delegating firm periodically confirms the relationship and can revoke it, rather than vetting individuals.

PHASE 2 · WITH TRADING Attestation is deferred in the mock; the Firm360 check and steward designation cover the parent case only. Relationship termination can land June or July 2027, with manual termination as the interim.

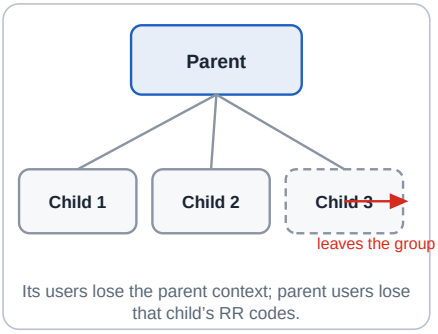
C · The solution choices Penny left open

These are not firm situations; they are decisions she handed over. The last column is the position the current mock takes.

Choice	Options	Her lean	Where the mock stands
Sub-advisor identity	One ID with several feature profiles (about three extra months) versus two credentials: home ID plus a trading-only sub-advisory ID	Two credentials, on time grounds, after getting R&D's cost of the one-ID option	Deferred to phase 2; the firm-scope card keeps the seam
Parent feature package	One global parent package with everything (manual) versus inherit from children versus from Firm360	Simple global package; no inheritance automation	Global package, child-only modules locked (Screen E)
Parent views in apps	Aggregate parent view versus toggle firm context per app versus firm labels in every module	Let Owen offer two options; Servicing already aggregates and cannot change	Not mocked; still Owen's app pass. The mock stops at provisioning
Firm360 dependency	Wait for Firm360 versus Compass keeps its own relationship model and syncs later	Don't wait: design with Owen and JP now, validate with Ray	Firm360 feed with a flagged manual row as the pilot bridge (Screen E)
The ~600 non-standard IDs	Build for them versus a tactical offline path until multi-firm removes the need	Tactical path	Routed to today's forms with a clear message in the request form

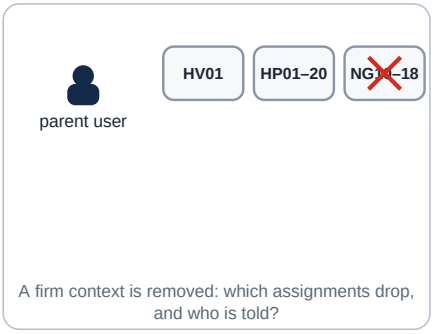
D · Transition cases she asked to be explored

No decisions yet; these are the questions to design for before a pilot grows beyond one group.



A child is added to or removed from a parent. What happens to the users already set up at the parent, and to the removed firm's own users?

A parent is dissolved. The group steward was set up at the parent; where is that person re-set-up, and who approves it?



A firm context is removed from a user. Which RR codes and features drop, is anything kept, and who is notified?

E · Explicitly out of scope, so nobody designs for it

Item	Why
Ghost parents (A6) and parent of a parent (A7); multi-parent moves (A8)	Not real relationships, or temporary
Multiple R2 IDs behind one Compass ID (A9)	Multi-firm removes the need; the one known case ends with systematic plans in Compass
Firm offboarding in the parent MVP	Not needed; delegation termination can land June or July 2027 with manual termination as the interim
Inheritance of features between parent and children	Direction of inheritance is not even defined; the global package replaces it
Billing logic in Compass	Metering only; invoicing stays with Firm360 and finance
Firm self-serve of core firm settings; bulk initial load of parent users; notifications on setups	Radhika configures on request; "stop building bulk tools"; assess notifications later